Wycliffe Associates

Bible Translation Reviewers' Guide

Matthew

1:18-25	3
2:1-12	5
3:13-17	7
4:1-11	8
5:1-12	10
6:1-15	12
9:18-26	14
11:25-27	16
13:44-46	20
14:13-21	21
14:22-35	23
16:13-28	25
17:1-9	29
18:21-35	31
19:16-30	32
20:1-16	36
22:1-14	38
24:36-51	40
27:1-10	42
28:1-20	44

Review Leader Instructions

Prepare

- Find 2–4 believers to review your translated passages, and plan where to meet.
- Gather pens and paper, a printed copy of the Reviewers' Guide (RG), one copy of the source text, and printed copies of the translation.

Start Review Session

- Bring everything you prepared.
- Welcome reviewers. Pray together.
- Tell reviewers the following:
    - "The questions in this review are not meant to test your Bible knowledge. Instead, they are meant to test how clear the translation is. When I ask questions, please answer from what you find in the text we just read."
    - "You will not be asked or expected to suggest changes or edits for any issues that are found."
    - "I will tell you the verse reference for each question. If needed, you can refer to that verse while answering the question."
- Give reviewers copies of the translated passages.

Conduct Review for Each Passage

- Read (aloud) any **Background** for the passage.
- Read (aloud) the passage in the translation. Reviewers should follow along while you read.
- Ask reviewers to retell the passage, using their own words. They may look at the passage as they retell it.
    - As you listen, mark the box by each **Part 1** item if it is understandable from the way reviewers retell the passage.
    - Write notes on the RG about what they understand and do not understand.
- Ask reviewers the **Part 2** questions. Tell reviewers the verse that each question is about so that they can look at the right verses as they answer.
    - As you listen, mark by each **Part 2** item if it is understandable from how reviewers answer the question. Reviewers do not need to quote directly.
    - As needed, ask additional questions to clarify. (For example, ask reviewers to show or tell which words in the verses led to their answer.)
    - You may also look at your source text to confirm answers.

  You may use the **Comment Section** to take any other notes about what they say.
    - Some questions in **Part 2** include the phrase "do you think." These questions are designed to test if implied information can be understood. Any answer that fits with the text is OK. Participants may also answer these questions based on knowledge of other Biblical passages and based on how they react to this passage.

Finish Review Session

- Pray together.
- Thank reviewers.
- As needed, talk about when to meet to review more passages.

After the Review

- Arrange a time to meet with the translation team.
- At that time, bring all the notes from your Review Session(s) to the translation team.
- Show them what was found by reviewers. The team should decide what to change and how to do that.

1:18-25

Background: The Gospel of Matthew is one of four books in the New Testament that describe some of the life of Jesus Christ. The authors of the gospels wrote about different aspects of who Jesus was and what he did. Matthew showed that Jesus was the Messiah and that God would save Israel through him. Matthew often explained that Jesus fulfilled the Old Testament prophecies about the Messiah. This may indicate that he expected most of his first readers to be Jewish.

In this passage, Joseph considered divorce. In Israel at the time of the New Testament, an engaged couple like Mary and Joseph would need to get a divorce in order to break their engagement.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ This story tells how the birth of Jesus came about. Mary was engaged to Joseph. Before they came together, Mary became pregnant by the Holy Spirit. [1:18]
- ☐ Joseph did not want to disgrace Mary, so he planned to divorce her quietly. [1:18-19]
- ☐ An angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream. The angel told Joseph to accept Mary as his wife, because Mary's baby was conceived by the Holy Spirit. [1:20]
- ☐ The angel told Joseph that Mary would have a son. The angel said to name this son Jesus, because he would save his people from their sins. [1:21]
- ☐ This happened to fulfill the prophecy that a virgin would conceive and bear a son who would be called Immanuel, which means "God with us." [1:22-23]
- ☐ Joseph did what the angel commanded and took Mary as his wife. [1:24]
- ☐ Joseph did not have sexual relations with Mary until her son was born. Joseph named the baby Jesus. [1:25]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [1:18] When did it become known that Mary was pregnant by the Holy Spirit?
   It became known that she was pregnant while she was engaged to Joseph, but before they were married.

2. [1:19] How was Joseph described in verse 19?
   He was called a righteous man.

3. [1:19] What did Joseph consider doing quietly when he found out that Mary was pregnant?
   He thought about divorcing her (or breaking the engagement).

4. [1:19] What do you think was the reason that Joseph considered divorcing Mary?
   It was probably because he knew that she was pregnant, and the baby was not his.

5. [1:20] What happened to change Joseph's mind?
   He had a dream, and an angel of the Lord told him not to be afraid to marry Mary.

Matthew 1:18-25 continued

6. [1:21] What was the reason that Joseph should name the baby Jesus?
   Jesus would save his people from their sins.

7. [1:22] What does verse 22 say about why all this happened?
   Everything happened the way it did to fulfill what the Lord said through a prophet long ago.

8. [1:23] Who did the prophet say would become pregnant and bear a son?
   The prophet said that a virgin would become pregnant and bear a son.

9. [1:23] What did the prophet say that people would call the baby?
   They would call the baby “Immanuel.”

10. [1:23] What does the name “Immanuel” mean?
    Immanuel means “God with us.”

11. [1:24] How did Joseph respond to what the angel said, after he awoke from the dream?
    He did what the angel commanded and took Mary as his wife.

12. [1:18-24] Who do you think the baby’s father was, according to this passage?
    The passage indicates that the baby’s father was God, because the angel said that the child was from the Holy Spirit. Joseph accepted that the child was from the Holy Spirit rather than from a man. The fulfilled prophecy also indicates this because the son that the virgin would bear would be called a word that means “God with us.”

13. [1:25] What did Joseph not do until the baby was born?
    Joseph did not have sexual relations with Mary until she gave birth to a son.

14. [1:25] What did Joseph name Mary’s son, just as the angel had told him to do in verse 21?
    Joseph named him Jesus.

Comment Section:

2:1-12

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Wise men came from the east to Jerusalem looking for the one who was born king of the Jews. [2:1-2]
- ☐ The chief priests and scribes told Herod that the Christ would be born in Bethlehem, according to scripture. [2:5-6]
- ☐ Herod sent the wise men to Bethlehem. [2:7-8]
- ☐ Herod ordered the wise men to return, telling them that he also wanted to worship the baby. [2:8]
- ☐ The wise men went to Bethlehem, found the baby, gave him gifts, and worshiped him. [2:11]
- ☐ They were warned by God in a dream not to go back to Herod, so they returned home another way. [2:12]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [2:1-2] After Jesus was born in Bethlehem, why did some wise men go to Jerusalem?
   They were looking for the one who had been born King of the Jews.

2. [2:2] Why were they looking for the King of the Jews?
   They said that they saw his star and were coming to worship him.

3. [2:3] Why do you think that Herod was troubled when he heard that the wise men wanted to find the King of the Jews who had just been born?
   (Answer may vary.) Herod was probably worried that a new king might take away his own position as king.

4. [2:4] How did Herod find out where the Christ would be born?
   He asked the priests and scribes of the Jewish people where Christ would be born.

5. [2:5-6] How did the priests and scribes know where Christ would be born?
   The scriptures said that a ruler would come from Bethlehem.

6. [2:9-10] How did the wise men find the one who was born king of the Jews?
   They left Jerusalem, and the star guided them to the house where the child was.

7. [2:11] What did the wise men do when they found the child?
   They fell down and worshiped him, and they opened their gifts and gave them to him.

8. [2:11] Who do you think the child was that they were worshiping?
   From the rest of the passage, it is clear that the child was Jesus.

9. [2:12] Why didn’t the wise men return to Herod?
   They had been warned by God in a dream not to return to Herod.

Matthew 2:1-12 continued

10. [2:2-6] Matthew told about the wise men coming to worship the one born king of the Jews, the prophecy about the ruler being born in Bethlehem, and the star over the house in Bethlehem where the child was. Why do you think Matthew told about these events?

    (Answer may vary.) Matthew probably told about these events to show that Jesus is the one that the Old Testament prophesied to be the King of the Jews.

Comment Section:

3:13-17

Background: After Jesus grew up, John the Baptist went into the wilderness and preached that people should stop sinning and be baptized. John also taught that someone more powerful than he would come, and that person would judge people.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus came to the Jordan River to be baptized by John. [3:13]
- ☐ John tried to stop Jesus, but Jesus said it was right for John to baptize him. [3:14-15]
- ☐ After John baptized Jesus, God's Spirit came down like a dove and rested on Jesus. [3:16]
- ☐ A voice from heaven said, "This is my beloved Son. I am very pleased with him." [3:17]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [3:14] When Jesus came to be baptized, what did John tell Jesus?
   John told Jesus that he needed to be baptized by Jesus.

2. [3:15] What did Jesus say was the reason that John should baptize him?
   It was right for them to fulfill all righteousness.

3. [3:16] What did the Spirit of God do when Jesus came out of the water?
   The Spirit of God came down and rested on Jesus.

4. [3:17] What did the voice from heaven say after Jesus came out of the water?
   The voice said, "This is my beloved Son. I am very pleased with him."

5. [3:17] Whose voice do you think was speaking?
   By saying the voice came out of heaven, the passage shows that it was the voice of God the Father. The voice also called Jesus "my Son."

6. [3:17] Who do you think God the Father was speaking about in verse 17?
   The passage shows that he was speaking about Jesus.

Comment Section:

4:1-11

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The Spirit led Jesus into the wilderness. [4:1]
- ☐ Jesus fasted, and he was hungry. [4:2]
- ☐ The devil tempted Jesus three times. [4:3-10]
- ☐ Each time, Jesus quoted scripture to the devil. [4:4-10]
- ☐ After the devil left him, angels came and served Jesus. [4:11]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [4:2] How long did Jesus fast?
   Jesus fasted for forty days.

2. [4:3] What did the devil first tempt Jesus to do?
   The devil tempted Jesus to command the stones to become bread.

3. [4:4] How did Jesus respond?
   Jesus quoted what was written about not living on just bread but on every word that comes out of the mouth of God.

4. [4:4] What do you think it means to live on God's word?
   (Answer may vary.) It may mean to believe God's word and obey it. It may mean that God's words are needed by all, just as food is.

5. [4:5-6] What did the devil next tempt Jesus to do?
   The devil tempted Jesus to throw himself down from the highest part of the temple building.

6. [4:7] How did Jesus respond?
   Jesus quoted what was written about not testing the Lord God.

7. [4:3, 6] When the devil tempted Jesus the first two times, what part of what he said was the same?
   Both times the devil said, "If you are the Son of God."

8. [4:3-4] Do you think that Jesus would have been able to turn the stones into bread? Why do you think that?
   (Answer may vary.) Probably Jesus would have been able to do that because he was the Son of God.

9. [4:8-9] What did the devil say that he would give to Jesus, if Jesus would fall down and worship him?
   The devil said that he would give Jesus all the kingdoms of the world.

Matthew 4:1-11 continued

10. [4:10] How did Jesus respond?
    Jesus told Satan to go away, and he quoted what was written about worshiping only the Lord God.

11. [4:4, 7, 10] Where do you think the words that Jesus quoted were written?
    Here and in other parts of the New Testament, the words “it is written” indicate that they were written in the scriptures—in the part of the Bible now called the Old Testament.

12. [4:4, 7, 10] Who or what did Jesus obey?
    Jesus obeyed God and his word.

Comment Section:

5:1-12

Background: Jesus went around teaching people to repent because the kingdom of God was near. He also told some men to follow him, and he healed many people. Large crowds of people followed him.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ Jesus went up on a mountain and taught his disciples. [5:1-2]

☐ Jesus described people who were blessed and then told how they would be blessed. [5:2-12]

☐ Jesus told the disciples to rejoice when they were persecuted for believing in him. [5:11-12]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [5:1-2] What did Jesus do when he saw the crowds?
   Jesus went up on a mountain and taught his disciples.

2. [5:3] Who does the kingdom of heaven belong to?
   It belongs to the poor in spirit.

3. [5:4] Who will be comforted?
   Those who mourn will be comforted.

4. [5:5] Who will inherit the earth?
   The meek will inherit the earth.

5. [5:6] Who will be filled?
   Those who hunger and thirst for righteousness will be filled.

6. [5:6] What do you think those who hunger and thirst for righteousness will be filled with?
   (Answer may vary.) The passage probably means they will be filled with righteousness.

7. [5:7] Who will receive mercy?
   The merciful will receive mercy.

8. [5:8] Who will see God?
   The pure in heart will see God.

9. [5:9] Who will be called sons of God?
   The peacemakers will be called sons of God.

Matthew 5:1-12 continued

10. [5:9] Why do you think the peacemakers will be called sons of God?
    (Answer may vary.) The passage might mean that by helping people to have peace with one another, they will reflect the character of God, who enables people to have peace with him.

11. [5:10] Who does the kingdom of heaven belong to?
    It belongs to those who are persecuted for righteousness' sake.

12. [5:11-12] Why would the disciples be blessed when others were cruel to them?
    They were blessed because their reward would be great in heaven, even though they were being persecuted like the prophets who lived before them.

Comment Section:

6:1-15

Background: Jesus continued to teach his disciples on the mountain.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus taught people not to do good works in order to be seen by other people. [6:1-4]
- ☐ Jesus taught people not to pray in order to be seen by other people. [6:5-8]
- ☐ Jesus taught people how to pray. [6:9-13]
- ☐ Jesus taught about forgiveness. [6:14-15]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [6:1] What did Jesus warn them against doing?
   He warned them not to do their good deeds to be seen by others.

2. [6:1] What did he say the result of doing their good deeds to be seen by others would be?
   Their Father in heaven would not reward them.

3. [6:1] Who do you think Jesus meant when he spoke of their Father in heaven?
   It is evident that he was talking about God the Father.

4. [6:2] Why did hypocrites sound a trumpet when they gave to the poor?
   Because they wanted other people to glorify them.

5. [6:3] When Jesus said not to let their left hand know what their right hand was doing, what do you think he meant?
   (Answer may vary.) He may have meant that they should do their good works so secretly that even those closest to them would not know about it. Or maybe it should become so customary or simple to do a good work that they might not even remember doing it.

6. [6:4, 6] What did Jesus say about the Father in verses 4 and 6?
   The Father sees who gives and prays in secret, and he will reward these people.

7. [6:8] What did he say the Father knows in verse 8?
   He knows what people need before they ask for it.

8. [6:8] What did Jesus tell his disciples to call God when they prayed?
   He told them to call him Father.

Matthew 6:1-15 continued

9. [6:9-13] What things did Jesus tell them to pray about?
   He said to pray for:
   - the Father's name to be honored as holy
   - his kingdom to come
   - his will to be done
   - their daily needs
   - forgiveness
   - protection from temptation and evil

10. [6:14] What did Jesus say the Father would do if they would forgive other people?
    He said the Father would forgive them.

11. [6:15] What would happen if they would not forgive others?
    The Father would not forgive them.

Comment Section:

9:18-26

Background: After Jesus taught his disciples on the mountain, he went to other places in Galilee, teaching and healing people.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ An official came to Jesus and asked him to bring his daughter back to life. [9:18]
- ☐ Jesus and his disciples went with the official. [9:19]
- ☐ A woman who had been sick for 12 years came up to Jesus in the crowd and touched his robe, because she believed that she would be healed if she only touched his garment. [9:20]
- ☐ Jesus told the woman that her faith had made her well. She was healed at once. [9:22]
- ☐ Jesus came to the house of the official, where there were flute players and a noisy crowd. [9:23]
- ☐ Jesus told them to go away, because the girl was not dead but sleeping. They laughed at him. [9:24]
- ☐ Jesus went in and took the girl by her hand, and she got up. [9:25]
- ☐ News about this spread throughout the area. [9:26]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [9:18] What did the official say to Jesus?
   The official told Jesus that his daughter had died, but that Jesus could put his hand on her and make her live.

2. [9:19] How did Jesus respond to the official's request?
   He got up and followed the official, along with his disciples.

3. [9:20] Who came up behind Jesus and touched the edge of his garment?
   A woman who had been bleeding for 12 years came up behind Jesus and touched the edge of his garment.

4. [9:21] Why did the woman touch his garment? [9:21]
   She said to herself that if she only touched his garment, she would be healed.

5. [9:22] What did Jesus call the woman?
   He called her "daughter."

6. [9:22] What did Jesus say to her?
   He told her to have courage because her faith had made her well.

7. [9:22] What happened right away when Jesus said that?
   The woman was healed.

Matthew 9:18-26 continued

8. [9:23] What did Jesus see when he got to the house of the official? [9:23]
   He saw flute players and a noisy crowd.

9. [9:24] What did Jesus say about the girl?
   He said that she was not dead but was sleeping.

10. [9:24] What did the crowd do when Jesus told them that the girl was asleep?
    The crowd laughed at him.

11. [9:25] What happened when Jesus went into the room, after the crowd was sent out?
    Jesus took the girl by the hand, and she got up.

12. [9:25] What do you think Jesus did for the girl?
    The passage indicates that she was dead, and Jesus made her alive.

13. [9:26] What happened after Jesus caused the girl to live?
    News about what Jesus did spread throughout that area.

Comment Section:

11:25-27

Background: Just before this passage, Jesus rebuked the towns who saw his miracles but did not turn from their sins.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus praised the Father for deciding to hide things from the wise and to reveal them to children. [11:25]
- ☐ Jesus said that it pleased the Father to do this. [11:26]
- ☐ Jesus said that the Father had entrusted everything to him. [11:27]
- ☐ Jesus said that only the Father knows the Son. [11:27]
- ☐ Jesus said that only the Son, and those to whom the Son reveals the Father, are the ones who know the Father. [11:27]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [11:25-26] Why did Jesus praise the Father?
   Jesus praised the Father because he had hidden things from the wise and revealed things to little children. He said that doing this pleased the Father.

2. [11:25-26] What kinds of things do you think Jesus meant that God had hidden from the wise?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps Jesus was talking about God not revealing to the wise who Jesus really is.

3. [11:25-26] Why do you think God would hide something from the wise but reveal it to little children?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps God reveals things to people who are like little children because they are humble and listen to him. Probably people who think that they are wise are prideful and will not listen to God.

4. [11:27] What did Jesus say that his Father had done?
   His Father had entrusted all things to him (Jesus).

5. [11:27] To whom do you think Jesus was referring when he spoke about his Father?
   The passage shows that he was referring to God the Father.

6. [11:27] Who knows the Son?
   Only the Father knows the Son.

7. [11:27] To whom was Jesus referring when he spoke about the Son?
   The passage indicates that he was referring to himself.

Matthew 11:25-27 continued

8. [11:27] Who knows the Father?
   Only the Son, and those to whom the Son reveals the Father, know the Father.

Comment Section:

12:22-29

Background: In this passage, a crowd asks if Jesus could be the Son of David. This was one of the names for God's promised Messiah.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ A man had a demon in him that made him blind and mute. Jesus healed him, and the man could see and talk. [12:22]
- ☐ The crowds were amazed. They asked if Jesus could be the Son of David. [12:23]
- ☐ The Pharisees said that Jesus was casting out demons by the power of the prince of demons. [12:24]
- ☐ Jesus knew their thoughts. He said that kingdoms divided against themselves would not last. [12:25]
- ☐ Jesus asked them how Satan's kingdom could last if Satan drove himself out. [12:26]
- ☐ Jesus asked them by whose power their sons drove out demons. He said their sons would be their judges. [12:27]
- ☐ Jesus said that if he drove out demons by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God had come among them. [12:28]
- ☐ Jesus asked how a person could steal from a strong man without tying up the strong man first. [12:29]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [12:22] Who did people bring to Jesus?
   They brought a man who had a demon inside him that made him blind and mute.

2. [12:22] What did Jesus do?
   Jesus healed the man. Then the man could speak and see.

3. [12:23] How did the crowd respond to this?
   They were amazed. They asked if Jesus could be the Son of David.

4. [12:24] What did the Pharisees say about Jesus?
   They said that Jesus cast out demons by Beelzebul, the prince of the demons.

5. [12:25] What did Jesus know about the Pharisees?
   He knew their thoughts.

6. [12:25] What did Jesus say would happen when a kingdom, city, or house is divided against itself?
   He said that such a kingdom would be ruined, and such a city or house would not last.

7. [12:25] What do you think Jesus meant when he said this?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps Jesus meant that if the people in these places were fighting against each other, they could not fight against their enemies. They would be destroyed.

Matthew 12:22-29 continued

8. [12:26] What question did Jesus ask the Pharisees?
   He asked them how Satan's kingdom could last if Satan was divided against himself and drove himself out.

9. [12:26] Why do you think that Jesus decided to ask them that question?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps he wanted them to realize that it was foolish to say that Jesus drove out demons by the power of the prince of demons.

10. [12:27] What other question did Jesus ask the Pharisees?
    He asked them by whose power their sons drove out demons.

11. [12:27] Who did Jesus say would be the judges of the Pharisees?
    He said that their sons would be their judges.

12. [12:28] What did Jesus say about the kingdom of God?
    Jesus said that if he drove out demons by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God had come among them.

13. [12:29] What did Jesus say about a strong man in verse 29?
    Jesus asked how anyone could enter the house of a strong man and take away his belongings without first tying up the strong man.

14. [12:29] Why do you think Jesus asked them this question?
    He probably wanted the Pharisees to admit that he did not work by Satan's power. Instead, Jesus had to overpower Satan in order to cast demons out of people.

Comment Section:

13:44-46

Background: Jesus went and sat down beside the sea. A large crowd gathered around him, and he used parables to teach them about the kingdom of God.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ Jesus said that the kingdom of heaven is like a treasure hidden in a field. [13:44]

☐ Jesus also said that the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant looking for valuable pearls. [13:45-46]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [13:44] How did Jesus describe the kingdom of heaven in verse 44?
   It is like a treasure hidden in a field.

2. [13:44] What did the man do when he found the treasure hidden in the field?
   The man hid the treasure and sold all his possessions and bought the field.

3. [13:44] Why do you think the man bought the field?
   He probably wanted the treasure that was hidden in the field.

4. [13:45] How did Jesus describe the kingdom of heaven in verse 45?
   The kingdom of heaven is like a man who was a merchant looking for valuable pearls.

5. [13:46] What did the man do when he found a very valuable pearl?
   He went and sold everything that he owned and bought it.

6. [13:44-46] Why do you think the two men in the stories sold everything they possessed?
   It appears that they sold everything so they could get enough money to buy the land and the pearl.

7. [13:44-46] What do you think was Jesus' reason for saying that the kingdom of heaven is like these things?
   (Answer may vary.) He seems to have meant that the kingdom of heaven is more important than anything else.

Comment Section:

14:13-21

Background: King Herod killed Jesus' cousin, John the Baptist. John's disciples went and told Jesus about it.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus went to a place far away from people, but the crowds followed him, and he had compassion on them. [14:13-14]
- ☐ Jesus told his disciples to feed the people, but they could only find a small amount of food. [14:15-18]
- ☐ Jesus blessed the food and gave it to the disciples, and they gave it to the people. [14:19]
- ☐ There was enough for over 5,000 people. After the people ate, there was a lot of food left over. [14:20-21]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [14:13] Where did Jesus go in a boat?
   He went to a place far away from people.

2. [14:14] What did Jesus do when he saw the large crowd of people?
   He had compassion on them, and he healed those who were sick.

3. [14:15] Why did the disciples want Jesus to send the crowds away?
   Because it was late in the day, the disciples knew the people needed to go to the villages to buy food.

4. [14:16] What did Jesus tell his disciples to do?
   He told them to give the people something to eat.

5. [14:17] How did the disciples reply to Jesus?
   They said that they had only five loaves of bread and two fish.

6. [14:17] Why do you think the disciples said this to Jesus?
   It appears that they were telling Jesus they did not have enough food to give to so many people.

7. [14:19] What did Jesus do with the food?
   He looked up to heaven, blessed the food, broke the loaves, and gave them to his disciples.

8. [14:20] After the people all ate, how much food was left over?
   Twelve baskets full of food were left over.

9. [14:21] How many people ate the food that Jesus provided?
   About 5,000 men, plus women and children, ate the food.

Matthew 14:13-21 continued

10. [14:15-21] What do you think was Jesus' reason for feeding the crowd?
    (Answer may vary.) He had compassion for the crowd. Perhaps he did this miracle to show them his glory and power. Perhaps he wanted them to think of how God provided for his people.

Comment Section:

14:22-35

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus' disciples got into a boat and went out on the sea. [14:22]
- ☐ At night, Jesus walked on the water to his disciples. He told them not to be afraid. [14:25-27]
- ☐ Peter walked toward Jesus on the water, but he began to sink. Jesus saved him. [14:29-31]
- ☐ The wind stopped blowing. [14:32]
- ☐ The disciples worshiped Jesus. [14:33]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [14:23] What did Jesus do on the mountain?
   He prayed.

2. [14:24] What happened while the disciples were in the boat?
   The wind blew strongly against them, and the boat was tossed around by the waves.

3. [14:25] What unusual thing did Jesus do in verse 25?
   Jesus walked to them on the water.

4. [14:26] Why do you think that the disciples thought that the person walking to them on the sea was a ghost?
   (Answer may vary.) They probably thought this because people have bodies that cannot walk on the sea.

5. [14:28] What did Peter ask Jesus to do to show that it really was him walking on the water?
   Peter asked Jesus to command him to go to him on the water.

6. [14:30] What happened when Peter was walking on the water, and he saw the wind?
   Peter became afraid, and he began to sink.

7. [14:30] What did Peter do when he began to sink?
   He cried out to the Lord to save him.

8. [14:31-32] How did Jesus save Peter?
   Jesus grabbed Peter and they went into the boat.

9. [14:32] What happened when Jesus and Peter went into the boat?
   The wind stopped blowing.

Matthew 14:22-35 continued

10. [14:33] How did the disciples respond?
    They worshiped Jesus and acknowledged that Jesus is the Son of God.

11. [14:25-32] What events in this passage do you think showed the disciples that Jesus was the Son of God?
    Jesus walked on the sea, Jesus enabled Peter to walk on the sea, and Jesus made the wind stop blowing.

12. [14:34-35] When the boat got to land, what did the men in that place do?
    They sent messages to the surrounding area, and people brought sick people to Jesus.

13. [14:36] What do you think was the reason that people wanted to touch the edge of Jesus' garment?
    (Answer may vary.) They probably believed (had faith) that just touching Jesus' garment would heal them.

14. [14:36] How many of those who touched Jesus' garment were healed?
    All people who touched it were healed.

Comment Section:

16:13-20

Background: When Jesus talked about himself, he sometimes called himself the Son of Man. Also, when this passage uses the phrase “flesh and blood,” it is referring to people on earth.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus asked his disciples who people said that the Son of Man was. [16:13]
- ☐ They replied that people said that he was John the Baptist, Elijah, Jeremiah, or another prophet. [16:14]
- ☐ Jesus asked who the disciples said that he was. [16:15]
- ☐ Peter said, “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God.” [16:16]
- ☐ Jesus said that Peter was blessed because Jesus’ Father in heaven had revealed this to Peter. [16:17]
- ☐ Jesus said that he would build his church on this rock, and the gates of Hades would not overpower it. [16:18]
- ☐ Jesus would bestow the keys of the kingdom, and what was bound or loosed on earth would be bound or loosed in heaven. [16:19]
- ☐ Jesus warned the disciples not to tell anyone that he was the Messiah. [16:20]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [16:13] What did Jesus ask his disciples?
   Jesus asked his disciples who people said that the Son of Man was.

2. [16:14] How did the disciples answer Jesus?
   They replied that some people said that he was John the Baptist, some said Elijah, some said Jeremiah, and some said one of the prophets.

3. [16:15] Then what did Jesus ask his disciples?
   He asked them who they said that he was.

4. [16:16] What did Simon Peter say?
   Peter said, “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God.”

5. [16:17] What did Jesus say to him in verse 17?
   Jesus said that Peter was blessed because this was not revealed to Peter by people (flesh and blood). Instead, Jesus’ Father in heaven revealed this to Peter.

6. [16:18] What did Jesus say that he would build his church on?
   Jesus would build his church on this rock.

Matthew 16:13-20 continued

7. [16:18] What would not overpower the church?
   Jesus said that the gates of Hades would not overpower the church.

8. [16:18] What do you think Jesus meant when he said that the gates of Hades would not overpower the church?
   He probably meant that evil and Satan will not be able to overpower the church.

9. [16:18] What do you think Jesus meant when he spoke about his church?
   He was probably talking about the group of people who would belong to him.

10. [16:19] What did Jesus say that he would give to Peter?
    Jesus said he would give to Peter the keys to the kingdom of heaven.

11. [16:19] What would be bound or loosed in heaven?
    What was bound or loosed on earth would be bound or loosed in heaven.

12. [16:20] What did Jesus command the disciples in verse 20?
    Jesus commanded the disciples not to tell anyone that he was the Christ.

Comment Section:

16:21-28

Background: In the previous passage, Peter confessed Jesus to be the Messiah, the Son of the Living God. Jesus told Peter that this was revealed to him by Jesus' Father in heaven, not by those on earth.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus began to tell his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem, suffer things from leaders there, and be killed, and then he would be raised on the third day. [16:21]
- ☐ Peter took Jesus aside and rebuked him. Peter said that this would never happen to Jesus. [16:22]
- ☐ Jesus said to Peter, "Get behind me, Satan!" Jesus said that Peter was setting his mind on the things of man, not the things of God. [16:23]
- ☐ Jesus taught them about what following him requires, and he said that those who follow him truly will be rewarded. [16:24-27]
- ☐ He said that some there would not experience death before they saw the Son of Man coming in his kingdom. [16:28]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

13. [16:21] What did Jesus begin to tell his disciples?
    Jesus began to tell the disciples that he must go to Jerusalem, suffer things from Jewish leaders, be killed, and be raised back to life on the third day.

14. [16:22] What did Peter do then?
    Peter took Jesus aside and rebuked him. He said that this must never happen to Jesus.

15. [16:23] What did Jesus say to Peter?
    Jesus said, "Get behind me, Satan!" He said that Peter was a stumbling block to him, because Peter thought about the things of man, not the things of God.

16. [16:24] What did Jesus say that his followers must do?
    Jesus said that they must deny themselves, take up their cross, and follow him.

17. [16:26] What do you think Jesus meant by his questions in verse 26?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps he meant that people who were too concerned about their earthly life would lose the opportunity to have life in heaven. His second question probably meant that anyone who was killed because of Jesus would have life in heaven.

18. [16:27] What did Jesus say that the Son of Man will do?
    He will come in the glory of his Father with his angels. Then he will reward people according to their deeds.

Matthew 16:21-28 continued

19. [16:28] What did Jesus say would happen in verse 28?
    Some of those who were there would not die until they saw the Son of Man coming in his kingdom.

Comment Section:

17:1-9

Background: This passage mentions Moses and Elijah, who were very important Jews that had lived hundreds of years before the time of the New Testament. Just before this passage, Jesus had said that some of his disciples would see him coming in his kingdom.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Six days later, Jesus went up on a mountain and took Peter, James, and John with him. [17:1]
- ☐ Jesus' appearance changed and became very bright. [17:2]
- ☐ Moses and Elijah appeared and talked with Jesus. [17:3]
- ☐ Peter said that it was good that he and the others were there. He offered to build shelters for Jesus, Moses, and Elijah. [17:4]
- ☐ While Peter was speaking, a bright cloud overshadowed them. A voice out of the cloud said, "This is my beloved Son. I am very pleased with him. Listen to him." [17:5]
- ☐ The disciples fell down in terror. [17:6]
- ☐ Jesus touched them and told them to get up. He told them not to be afraid. [17:7]
- ☐ When the disciples looked up, only Jesus was there. [17:8]
- ☐ They came down from the mountain. Jesus told them not to tell others about what they had seen until after he was raised from the dead. [17:9]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [17:1] What did Jesus do in verse 1?
   He took Peter, James, and John up onto a mountain with him.

2. [17:2] When Jesus, Peter, James, and John were on the mountain, what happened to Jesus?
   His appearance changed greatly.

3. [17:2] How did Jesus' appearance change?
   His face shone like the sun, and his clothes became as bright as the light.

4. [17:3] Who appeared and spoke with Jesus?
   Moses and Elijah appeared with Jesus and talked with him.

5. [17:3] Why do you think it would have been surprising to the disciples to see Moses and Elijah speaking with Jesus?
   It would probably be surprising because Moses and Elijah had lived long before this time. (They were not still living on earth when Jesus and his disciples were on the earth.) The disciples may also have been surprised because Moses and Elijah were very important people to the Jews.

Matthew 17:1-9 continued

6. [17:4] What did Peter say?
   Peter said that it was good that he and the others were there. Then Peter offered to build shelters for Jesus, Moses, and Elijah.

7. [17:5] What did the voice out of the cloud say, while Peter was still speaking?
   The voice said, “This is my beloved Son. I am very pleased with him. Listen to him.”

8. [17:5] Whose voice do you think spoke out of the cloud?
   The passage indicates that it was the voice of God the Father that spoke, because the voice came from heaven, and because the voice said that Jesus was his Son.

9. [17:5] What person was the voice speaking about when it said, “This is my Son, whom I love”?
   The passage indicates that the voice was speaking about Jesus.

10. [17:6] How did Jesus’ disciples react when they heard the voice?
    They fell down to the ground, very afraid.

11. [17:7] What did Jesus do next?
    He touched them and told them to get up. He told them not to be afraid.

12. [17:8] Who did the disciples see when they looked up?
    They saw no one other than Jesus.

13. [17:9] What did Jesus command, as they came down the mountain?
    He told them not to tell anyone else about this until after the Son of Man had been raised from the dead.

Comment Section:

18:21-35

Background: This passage mentions 2 amounts of money. The first amount of money, 10,000 talents, was a huge amount. It was the payment for men to do many years of work. The second amount of money, 100 denarii, was much less. It was the payment for one man to do a few months of work.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Peter asked Jesus how many times to forgive a brother that sinned against him. He asked if he should forgive as many as 7 times. [18:21]
- ☐ Jesus told a story about the kingdom of heaven to teach them about forgiveness. [18:22-35]
- ☐ The king was settling his accounts, and a servant who owed him a very large debt would need to be sold along with his family to pay the debt. [18:23-25]
- ☐ The servant pleaded for mercy, and the king chose to forgive the debt entirely. [18:26-27]
- ☐ When the servant left, he found a man who owed him a small amount of money and demanded for it to be paid right away. [18:28]
- ☐ Even though the man begged for time to pay, the forgiven servant refused and had the man thrown into prison. [18:29-30]
- ☐ Other servants of the king saw this and were upset, so they told the king what had happened. [18:31]
- ☐ The king called back the servant and told him he was wicked and should have shown mercy to the man who owed him, just like the king had shown mercy. Because he had not shown mercy, the servant would be handed over to be tortured until he could pay his debt. [18:32-34]
- ☐ Jesus said that this is how his heavenly Father would deal with anyone who refuses to forgive his brother. [18:35]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [18:21] What did Peter ask Jesus?
   Peter asked how many times he should forgive a brother who sinned against him. He asked if it should be up to 7 times.

2. [18:22] How many times did Jesus say to forgive the brother?
   Jesus said it should not be 7 times. Instead, it should be 70 times 7.

3. [18:24] In Jesus' story, how much did the first servant owe the king?
   The first servant owed 10,000 talents to the king.

4. [18:25] What did the king say should happen to the servant?
   The servant should be sold, along with his wife and children and everything he had.

Matthew 18:21-35 continued

5. [18:25] How do you think selling the servant and his family and possessions would help?
   It would probably provide money to pay what the servant owed.

6. [18:26] What did the servant say to the king?
   He begged the king to be patient, and then he would pay everything to the king.

7. [18:27] How did the king respond?
   The king was compassionate. He released the servant and forgave his debt.

8. [18:28] What did the first servant do when he found a fellow servant who owed him a smaller amount of money?
   He began to choke that fellow servant and demanded payment.

9. [18:24, 28] Compare how much the two servants owed.
   The first servant owed a very large amount to the king. The second servant owed a much smaller amount to the first servant.

10. [18:29] What did that second servant say?
    He begged the first servant to be patient with him, and then he would pay everything to the first servant.

11. [18:30] What did the first servant do?
    He refused to have mercy. Instead, he threw the second servant into prison.

12. [18:31] How did other servants react when they saw this happen?
    They felt grieved, and they told the king about it.

13. [18:32] How did the king react?
    He summoned the first servant and told him that he was evil.

14. [18:32-34] Why was the king so angry with the first servant?
    The king had forgiven all of the first servant's large debt. That first servant should have had mercy on the second servant, and he should have forgiven him for the smaller debt.

15. [18:34] What did the king do to the first servant?
    He handed that servant over to the torturers until he paid all that he owed.

16. [18:35] What did Jesus say would happen to people who do not forgive other people?
    His heavenly Father will do the same as the king in the story did.

17. [18:21-35] How do you think that this parable addresses Peter's question about forgiveness?
    It shows that God is like the king in the story. God is very forgiving and has forgiven people for so much. Therefore, people should not put a limit on how much they forgive other people.

Comment Section:

19:16-30

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ A man asked Jesus what good thing he should do to gain eternal life. [19:16]
- ☐ Jesus said that only one was good. He said that, to enter life, the young man should keep the commandments. [19:17]
- ☐ The man asked which commandments to keep. Jesus mentioned several commandments. [19:18-19]
- ☐ The young man told Jesus that he had kept all those commandments. He asked what else he lacked. [19:20]
- ☐ Jesus told the young man that if he wanted to be perfect, he should sell his possessions and give to the poor. Then he should follow Jesus. [19:21]
- ☐ The young man went away sadly, because he had many possessions. [19:22]
- ☐ Jesus told his disciples that it was very difficult for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God. [19:23-24]
- ☐ The disciples were amazed at this and asked who then could be saved. [19:25]
- ☐ Jesus said that with people, it was impossible. But with God, all things are possible. [19:26]
- ☐ Peter said that the disciples had left everything to follow Jesus. He asked what they would then have. [19:27]
- ☐ Jesus said that when the Son of Man was on his throne, they would sit on 12 thrones and judge Israel. [19:28]
- ☐ Jesus said that those who had left things and people for him will receive much more and will have eternal life. [19:29]
- ☐ Jesus said that the first would be last and the last would be first. [19:30]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [19:16] What did the man ask Jesus?
   He asked Jesus what good thing he should do in order to have eternal life.

2. [19:17] What did Jesus say about what is good?
   He said that there is only one who is good.

3. [19:17] Who do you think that Jesus meant when he said that only one is good?
   (Answer may vary.) He probably meant that only the one God is good. Because Jesus is God, Jesus could have meant that he himself is the only one who is good.

4. [19:17] What did Jesus tell the man to do if he wanted to enter into life?
   Jesus told him to obey the commandments.

5. [19:18] How did the man reply?
   He asked Jesus, “Which commandments?”

Matthew 19:16-30 continued

6. [19:18-19] Which commandments did Jesus say that the young man must obey?
    - Do not murder
    - Do not commit adultery
    - Do not steal
    - Do not bear false witness
    - Honor your father and your mother
    - Love your neighbor as yourself

7. [19:20] How did the young man answer Jesus?
    The young man said that he had obeyed all these commands. Then he asked Jesus what he still lacked.

8. [19:21] How did Jesus answer the young man?
    He told the young man that if he wanted to be perfect, he should sell his possessions and give to the poor, and he would have treasure in heaven. Jesus invited the man then to come follow him.

9. [19:22] Why did the young man go away sadly?
    The young man went away sadly because he had many possessions.

10. [19:22] Why do you think that having many possessions caused the man to sadly leave Jesus?
    This seems to indicate that the man did not want to sell his possessions and to give to the poor. It implies that the man thought that it was more important to keep his many possessions than to follow Jesus.

11. [19:23-24] What did Jesus say to his disciples then?
    Jesus said that it is difficult for a rich man to enter the kingdom of heaven. He said that it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

12. [19:25] How did his disciples respond?
    They were astonished and asked who then could be saved.

13. [19:25] Why do you think that the disciples reacted this way?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps they thought that if people were rich, it was because those people were good, and so God was blessing them. If such rich people could not enter into God's kingdom, then the disciples did not know what kind of people could enter.

14. [19:26] How did Jesus answer the disciples?
    He said that with people this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.

15. [19:27] What did Peter say to Jesus?
    Peter said that the disciples had left everything and followed Jesus. He wondered what they would get.

16. [19:28] How did Jesus answer Peter and the disciples?
    Jesus told them that in the coming time, they would sit on 12 thrones and judge the 12 tribes of Israel.

17. [19:29] What did Jesus say to the disciples in verse 29?
    He said that everyone who had left possessions or family for his sake would receive much more and would inherit eternal life.

Matthew 19:16-30 continued

18. [19:30] What did Jesus say in verse 30?
    He said that many who were first will be last, and those who were last will be first.

19. [19:30] What do you think Jesus meant when he said that?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps he meant that many people who were considered to be important in this world will not be important in the kingdom of heaven, and that many who were considered to be unimportant in this world will be very important in the kingdom of heaven.

Comment Section:

20:1-16

Background: In this passage, Jesus told a story to explain what the kingdom of heaven is like, after he was asked what Peter and the other disciples would receive because they gave up everything to follow Jesus. This passage mentions a denarius, which was the usual amount of money paid for a full day of work in the time of the New Testament.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The kingdom of heaven is like a landowner who went out early to hire men to work in his vineyard. [20:1]
- ☐ He agreed to pay the men a denarius for the day, and he sent them into his vineyard. [20:2]
- ☐ He saw others standing idle at later times of the day. He told them to go into the vineyard. He said that he would give them what was right. He even hired some men at the eleventh hour who had not been hired earlier. [20:3-7]
- ☐ In the evening, the landowner had his foreman pay the workers, starting with the last group that he had hired. Each worker hired at the eleventh hour received a denarius. [20:8-9]
- ☐ The workers who were hired earlier saw this. They thought that they would receive more payment. Instead, each worker received a denarius, regardless of when they had begun their work. [20:9-10]
- ☐ The workers who were hired earlier complained because those who were hired last received the same payment as they had, without working as long in the sun. [20:11-12]
- ☐ The landowner said that he did not do wrong to them, because each one received the payment that they had agreed about. [20:13]
- ☐ The landowner had decided to give the same payment to the workers who were hired later, and that was lawful for him to do. He asked if the others were envious because of his generosity. [20:14-15]
- ☐ At the end of the story, Jesus said that the last will be first, and the first will be last. [20:16]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [20:1-3] What did the landowner do to get workers for his vineyard?
   He went to the marketplace and hired people to work for him.

2. [20:2] When he hired the first group, how much did he say that he would give them?
   He said that he would give them one denarius a day.

3. [20:3-4] What did he say to others that he saw standing idle three hours later?
   He told them to go into his vineyard, too, and he would give them what was right.

4. [20:5-7] At what other times did he hire more idle men to be workers?
   He hired some workers at the sixth hour, some at the ninth hour, and some at the eleventh hour.

Matthew 20:1-16 continued

5. [20:8] At the end of the day, what did the landowner tell his foreman to do?
   He told his foreman to pay the workers, starting with the ones who were hired last.

6. [20:9] How much did the laborers who were hired last, at the eleventh hour, receive?
   They each received a denarius.

7. [20:10] What happened when the first laborers who were hired came to be paid?
   They thought that they would receive more, but each of them received a denarius.

8. [20:11-12] Explain why the laborers who were hired first became upset with how much payment they received.
   They felt cheated because they got the same payment as the ones who worked only for a short time. The laborers who were hired earlier had to do most of the work, and it was during the hot part of the day.

9. [20:13] Did the landowner cheat the first workers that he hired?
   He did not cheat them. He gave them the amount that they had agreed upon.

10. [20:14] What did the landowner ask the workers who were hired earlier?
    He asked them whether he had the right to do what he wished with the money that belonged to him. He asked them if they were envious because of his generosity to other people.

11. [20:1, 15-16] What do you think that Jesus meant when he said that the kingdom of heaven is like this?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps this meant that God planned to show grace to people that might not have followed Jesus as long or had not given up as much as Peter and the other disciples had done. Perhaps it meant that God would show grace to Gentiles who had not worked to follow the Law of Moses as the Jewish people had done. Perhaps it was a warning against envy, or against comparing how God's grace is shown to different people. Perhaps this meant that all God's rewards are gifts, and God gives them in a way that pleases himself.

Comment Section:

22:1-14

Background: Jesus told many parables, which were stories to explain what the kingdom of heaven is like.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus said that the kingdom of heaven is like a marriage feast that a king prepared for his son. [22:1-2]
- ☐ The king invited people to the feast, but some ignored the message, others refused to come, and some even mistreated the messengers. [22:3-6]
- ☐ The king sent his army to destroy those unworthy murderers. [22:7-8]
- ☐ Then he told his servants to go invite other people to the wedding feast. [22:8-10]
- ☐ One man who came to the feast was not wearing wedding clothes, and he would not say why. [22:11-12]
- ☐ The king told his servants to throw that man into the outer darkness. [22:13]
- ☐ Jesus ended the story by saying that many people are called, but few are chosen. [22:14]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [22:1] How did Jesus speak to the people?
   Jesus spoke to the people in parables.

2. [22:2] What did Jesus say the kingdom of heaven is like?
   He said that the kingdom of heaven is like a king who prepared a marriage feast for his son.

3. [22:3] How did people respond when the king first sent servants to invite them to the wedding feast?
   They were unwilling to come.

4. [22:4-5] What happened when the king sent more servants to say that the wedding feast was ready?
   Those who were invited paid no attention. They did other things.

5. [22:6] What else did some of the people who were invited to the feast do?
   They seized the king's servants, treated them shamefully, and killed them.

6. [22:7] How did the king respond?
   The king was angry. He sent his soldiers,` and they destroyed those people and burned their city.

Matthew 22:1-14 continued

7. [22:8-9] Then what did the king tell his servants to do, instead of talking to the unworthy people that were first invited?
   He told them to go out to the roads and invite as many people to the marriage feast as they could find, both good and evil.

8. [22:11] What did the king see when he came in to look at his guests?
   He saw a man there who was not wearing wedding clothes.

9. [22:12] What did the king say to the man without wedding clothes?
   He called him friend, and he asked how the man had come in there without wedding clothes.

10. [22:12] What did the man say to the king?
    Nothing. He was speechless.

11. [22:13] What happened to the man without wedding clothes?
    The king had his servants threw him into the outer darkness.

12. [22:14] What did Jesus say at the end of the parable?
    He said that many people are called, but few are chosen.

13. [22:14] How do you think the kingdom of heaven is like this parable?
    (Answer may vary.) The passage indicates that God invites people to belong to his kingdom, but many refuse. So, God invites other people to be part of his kingdom. Perhaps this was a story meant that the people of Israel had refused to listen to God's prophets, and had even mistreated and killed them, so now God was going to invite others to be his people.

Comment Section:

24:36-51

Background: In the Old Testament, God commanded a man named Noah to build a large ship called an ark. Only Noah and his family entered the ark, which saved them from the flood that killed the rest of the people on earth.

Before this passage, Jesus' disciples asked him to tell them the signs of his coming at the end of the age. Jesus had begun to answer them.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus said that nobody but the Father knows what day and hour the Son of Man will come. [24:36]
- ☐ Jesus said that the coming of the Son of Man will be like the days of Noah, when people were doing ordinary things and were not ready when the flood came. [24:37-39]
- ☐ Jesus gave examples of people who will be taken and left at that time. [2:40-41]
- ☐ He said that his followers need to be alert, because no one knows the time of his coming any more than people know beforehand what time a thief will be coming. [24:42-43]
- ☐ Jesus told his disciples to be ready, because the Son of Man will come at a time that they do not expect. [24:44]
- ☐ Jesus told how a master who returns home at an unexpected time will treat his faithful servants and his wicked servants. [24:45-51]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [24:36] Who did Jesus say knows the day and hour when the Son of Man will come at the end of the age?
   Jesus said that only the Father knows this.

2. [24:37-39] How did Jesus compare the coming of the Son of Man to the days of Noah?
   Until the day that Noah entered the ark, people were doing ordinary things and did not understand what would happen until it was too late, because the flood came and swept them all away. Jesus said that the coming of the Son of Man will be the same way.

3. [24:40-42] What did Jesus say about two men working in a field and two women grinding with a mill in that time?
   He said that one of each pair will be taken, and one of each pair will be left.

4. [2:40-42] Why do you think that the same thing will not happen to both women and to both men?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps one of each pair of people will be ready when the Son of Man comes, and the other will not be ready.

5. [24:42] Why did Jesus warn his disciples to be on guard or stay alert?
   He said this because people do not know which day the Lord will come. So they must be ready for it at any time.

Matthew 22:1-14 continued

6. [24:43-44] Why would the master of the house have stayed alert if he had known when the thief was coming?
   The master would have stayed alert so that he could keep the thief from breaking into his house.

7. [24:44] How do you think that the Son of Man coming is like a thief coming?
   People do not know when the Son of Man will come, just as they do not know when a thief will come.

8. [24:45-46] Who is the wise and faithful servant?
   He is a person who carefully watches over the master's household until the master returns.

9. [24:47] What will the master do for the faithful servant?
   The master will set the faithful servant over all the master’s possessions.

10. [24:48-49] Who is the evil servant?
    The evil servant says to himself that his master is delayed, and then he begins to mistreat his fellow servants.

11. [24:50-51] When the master returns at an unexpected time, what will he do to the evil servant?
    The master will destroy him and put him with the hypocrites, where there will be weeping and grinding of teeth.

Comment Section:

27:1-10

Background: Some of the religious leaders made a plot to arrest Jesus. They gave money to Judas, one of Jesus' disciples, and Judas led them to Jesus at night. They arrested Jesus and took him to the High Priest. The High Priest said that Jesus deserved to die. This passage mentions the prophet Jeremiah, who had lived hundreds of years earlier. His prophecies are recorded in the Old Testament.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ The chief priest and elders delivered Jesus to Pilate, the governor, to put him to death. [27:1-2]
- ☐ When Judas saw that Jesus had been condemned, he felt bad and returned the 30 pieces of silver to the chief priests. [27:3-4]
- ☐ When the chief priest and elders would not take back the silver, Judas threw the silver into the temple. Then he went out and hanged himself. [27:4-5]
- ☐ The chief priest took the money and bought the potter's field. [27:6-8]
- ☐ This fulfilled what Jeremiah the prophet had said would happen. [27:9-10]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [27:1-2] What happened after the chief priest and elders plotted to put Jesus to death?
   They bound Jesus and delivered him to Pilate the governor.

2. [27:2-3] What did Judas do when he saw Jesus had been condemned to death?
   He changed his mind and tried to return the 30 pieces of silver to the chief priests.

3. [27:4] What do you think Judas meant when he said that he betrayed innocent blood?
   He probably meant that when he betrayed Jesus, he betrayed an innocent person, and now that innocent person was going to die.

4. [27:4] What did the chief priest and elders tell Judas when he said that he had betrayed innocent blood?
   They asked what it had to do with them. They told Judas that it was his own responsibility.

5. [27:5] What did Judas do?
   Judas threw the 30 pieces of silver into the temple. Then he went away and hanged himself.

6. [27:6] What do you think the chief priests meant when they said that the silver was the price of blood in verse 6?
   They probably meant that the silver had been used to pay for someone to be killed.

7. [27:7] What did the chief priest and elders do with the silver that Judas threw into the temple?
   They bought the potter's field in which to bury strangers.

Matthew 27:1-10 continued

8. [27:8] What was the potter's field then called?
   The field was called the Field of Blood.

9. [27:9-10] How did this event fulfill Jeremiah's prophecy?
   Jeremiah prophesied that people would take 30 pieces of silver, the price that was set on someone by the sons of Israel, and they would buy a potter's field. In Matthew, the chief priests took the 30 pieces of silver that they paid Judas so that they could arrest and kill Jesus, and they bought a potter's field.

Comment Section:

28:1-20

Background: Pilate held a short trial for Jesus. Then he gave Jesus to the soldiers to crucify him. They crucified Jesus, and he died. Many women who followed Jesus were watching. A disciple named Joseph buried Jesus' body in a tomb and rolled a stone in front of it. Two disciples, who were each named Mary, watched. The chief priests sealed the tomb and posted a guard so that no one could go inside and steal Jesus' body.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Two women went to the tomb early in the morning. [28:1]
- ☐ An angel came down and rolled away the stone from the tomb. [28:2-3]
- ☐ The guards were terrified and became like dead men. [28:4]
- ☐ The angel told the women that Jesus was not there, because Jesus had risen. The angel told them to come see the place where Jesus had been. [28:5-6]
- ☐ Then the angel told the women to go tell the disciples that Jesus had risen. [28:7]
- ☐ The women ran to tell the disciples. Then Jesus met the women and spoke to them. They worshiped him. [28:8-9]
- ☐ Jesus said that the women should go tell the disciples to come to Galilee, where they would see him. [28:10]
- ☐ The guards reported to the chief priests what had happened. [28:11]
- ☐ The chief priests gave money to the guards to lie and say that the disciples had stolen Jesus' body. [28:12-15]
- ☐ Jesus' disciples went and met him in Galilee. Some worshiped him, but some doubted. [28:16-17]
- ☐ Jesus told them to make disciples of all nations, and to baptize and teach them. He told the disciples that he would always be with them. [28:18-20]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [28:1] What happened at dawn on the first day of the week?
   Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to see the tomb.

2. [28:2] What happened as Mary Magdalene and the other Mary came to the tomb?
   There was a great earthquake. An angel of the Lord came and rolled away the stone and sat on it.

3. [28:3] What did the angel of the Lord look like?
   His appearance was like lightning, and his clothing was very white.

4. [28:4] What did the guards do when the angel of the Lord appeared?
   The guards shook with fear and became like dead men.

Matthew 28:1-20 continued

5. [28:5] What did the angel say to the women?
   He told them not to be afraid. He told them that he knew that they were looking for Jesus, who had been crucified.

6. [28:6] What did the angel tell them about Jesus in verse 6?
   The angel told them that Jesus was not there but had risen, just as he had said that he would do.

7. [28:6] What did the angel tell the women to come and see?
   He told them to come see the place where the Lord lay.

8. [26:6] Why do you think the angel told them to come and see where the Lord lay?
   The angel probably did this because seeing the empty tomb would help the women to know that the Lord really had risen from the dead.

9. [28:6-7] What do you think it means that Jesus was risen, or was risen from the dead?
   The passage indicates that these words mean that Jesus came back to life after he had died.

10. [28:7] What did the angel tell the women to do?
    He said they must tell the disciples that Jesus had risen from the dead.

11. [28:8] What did the women do?
    The women left the tomb and ran to tell the disciples.

12. [28:9] What happened after the women left the tomb?
    Jesus met the women, and they worshiped him.

13. [28:10] What did Jesus tell the women?
    He told them not to be afraid. He said to tell his brothers to leave for Galilee, where they would see Jesus.

14. [28:11] What did the soldiers do after they left the tomb?
    They told the chief priests what had happened.

15. [28:12] What did the chief priests and elders do?
    They gave a large amount of money to the soldiers.

16. [28:13-14] What did they say to the soldiers?
    They said that the soldiers must tell people that the disciples of Jesus came by night and stole Jesus' body while the soldiers were sleeping. They said that they would win over the governor and keep the soldiers out of trouble.

17. [28:15] What did the soldiers do?
    The soldiers took the money and did what the chief priests and elders had told them to do.

18. [28:16] Where did the eleven disciples go?
    The eleven disciples went to a mountain in Galilee, where Jesus had directed them to go.

19. [28:17] What did the disciples do when they saw Jesus?
    They worshiped him, but some doubted.

Matthew 28:1-20 continued

20. [28:18] What did Jesus say had been given to him?
    All authority in heaven and earth had been given to him.

21. [28:18-19] What did Jesus tell his disciples to do, because of all the authority that had been given to him?
    Jesus told them to make disciples of all nations and to baptize them into the name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit.

22. [28:19] What do you think it means to make disciples?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps it means to teach people to do all that Jesus had said, as the next verse indicates. Perhaps it also means to help others to believe in and to follow Jesus.

23. [28:19] What do you think it means to baptize people into the name of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps it means that baptizing people is a sign that they are saved by faith in the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, or that they are under the authority of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. Perhaps it also means that the names of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit should be said as people get baptized.

24. [28:20] What did Jesus tell the disciples to do?
    He told them to teach the people of the nations to obey what he said.

25. [28:20] What else did Jesus say to the disciples in verse 20?
    Jesus said that he would be with them always.

Comment Section: